

Working with Some Jobsites@india

Jobsdb.com

It had 910 jobs on its list when we visited it. Apart from posting your resume and searching for jobs, you can look up some career resources such as preparing for interviews. As usual, you can search for jobs by keywords, date, etc, but what really stands out is the vast categorisation of jobs. Registration allows you to receive personalised alerts and market yourself to prospective employers. You can also scan through job offers in a few other countries.

Monsterindia.com

At the Indian counterpart of Monster.com (one of the biggest job sites in the world), you can set up your own e-mail account and search for jobs across a wide category. The regular sections on expert advice on preparing a resume, career advice, etc, are present, as also a list of favourite companies. One aspect you notice is that a job search reveals a detailed description of the job, along with company details and not just some basic information as on some sites.

Naukri.com

This is an extensive job portal, and also includes some job offers abroad. The site uses free resume managers to upload your resume and get free alerts and claims to have covered more than 11,000 companies. You can also avail of a column with free counseling advice. And one of the columns also gives a listing of various recruitment services. You can apply for daily newsletters on the site to get free updates about vacancies.

The Upside and the Downside

Top 10 reasons for registering at a job site

1. Comprehensive job listings for India and abroad
2. Daily mailers and updates for job offers
3. Space for salary negotiations
4. Message boards to share views and opinions with communities such as IT, management, finance, etc
5. Career counselling, tips to improve your interview skills, etc
6. Expert advice from people successful in their professions
7. Articles and analysis regarding various careers and job profiles
8. Links to latest happenings and news affecting

the job market

9. Information about emerging career opportunities
10. Walk-in interview alerts

The shortfalls

1. Acknowledgements upon registration and responses to job queries are not always prompt
2. Very few non-IT jobs listed
3. Contact details are usually not given
4. E-mail updates may not be that up-to-date, as companies fail to alert the job site if the vacancy is filled through other means
5. The matchmaking process is not foolproof. You get alerts for jobs that don't match the criteria specified

to keep yourself posted about consultancy services and placement agencies, **Naukri.com** and **Jobsahead.com** have a listing with complete contact details.

Caution! Work in progress

But looking beyond the hype, are these sites actually getting the job done? While the going seems good, Indian job sites still have a long way to go before they can measure up to their international counterparts. The biggest problem with almost all the sites right now is the unavailability of non-IT jobs.

There are hardly any job postings or alerts related to, say, photography or media. Job openings abroad are also usually restricted to a few categories: IT, telecom, HR, finance, management and sales. Another bothersome aspect is that the newsletters informing you about the list of vacancies rarely provide the telephone number of the companies, and the recipients are forced to find it out for themselves.

"There's one frustrating thing about the newsletters. It is really difficult to get the contact details, as you are only given links to the sites," says Ranade. "And the worst part is, after all the rigmarole of sending your resumes through, you hardly ever get a response. In fact, some of my friends had to call the employers over the phone to fix an appointment," she adds.

Also, the e-mail updates may not be that up-to-date, as Rekha Banerjee found out. "After resigning from my company, I had availed of the free service by **jobsahead.com** with a dream job in mind." However, she happened to get into the company she wanted without help from jobsa-



I applied on behalf of my uncle for a non-IT senior management job...but it was a waste of money as the vacancy we were alerted about was partially IT-related

Ankush Garg

Quality Management, Forindia.com

head.com. "Just after I joined my dream company, I found an alert in my mail box about a vacancy in the same organisation." It turned out to be the vacancy that she had already filled!

Ankush Garg, working in quality management at forindia.com also had his patience tested by these sites. "My uncle wanted a non-IT senior level management job and I applied for him at the payment service with **jobsahead.com** and the free service with **naukri.com**. I received a response from **jobsahead.com** in 13-14 days... better than **naukri.com**, which still hasn't given me a single acknowledgement," says Garg.

"However, it was a waste of money, as the vacancy we were alerted about was for an electronics company and was partially IT-related," he adds. The matchmaking process still needs a bit of tweaking. The jobs offered may not meet the desired criteria, especially if you're looking for something non-IT or at a senior level.

The bottom line is that job sites are no manna from heaven. But if you get over that 'perfect job' mania, they have a lot to offer you. Maybe even a near-perfect job. ■

Tried hunting for a job through one of these sites? Write all about it to readersletters@jasubhai.com